DEVELOPING CONFIDENCE IN UNDERSERVED GROUPS

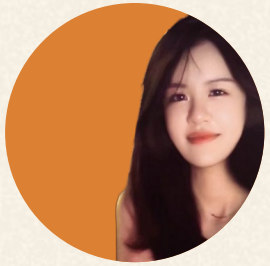
Improving Author Confidence

Authors don’t publish in a vacuum.
It’s all about relationships.

Team 2: Increasing Author Confidence · COMMLD 560: Inclusive Design & Product Equity · Summer 2026

THE TEAM

A mix of digital media & information professionals



Yenn Yang

MCDM 25



Logan Bennett

MCDM 25



Donna Jo

MSIM 27



Chase Broderick

MCDM 26



WHAT QUESTIONS DO AUTHORS HAVE ABOUT SELF-PUBLISHING?

“Do I need to register my copyright?”

“Do I need to set up pre-orders?”

“How do I market my book if I don’t have an audience?”

“Do I need an editor? What about a professional editor?”

“Is there a reader for my book?”

What we’ll cover today

1. Understanding Research: What Makes Authors Confident?
2. Product Equity Proposal: Introducing a “Confidence Hub”
3. Digging Deeper and Metrics

> **"Feedback is the fuel that keeps the writing process moving forward."**
>
> — *Heather J.S. Birch*, writing researcher



UNDERSTANDING THE RESEARCH

Confidence and Authorship

THREE CORE RESEARCH QUESTIONS

01



CONFIDENCE JOURNEY

What shapes confidence before, during & after publishing?

02



AUDIENCE GROWTH

How can new indie authors market and build readership?

03



PUBLISHING MOMENTUM

Does greater confidence lead to more frequent publishing?

Q1

What shapes author confidence across the KDP journey?

1



MASTERY

Success at the task is the strongest confidence driver.

Bandura: self-efficacy theory

2



VISIBLE PROGRESS

Seeing personal progress builds confidence more than reader reactions.

3



HEALTHY METRICS

Always-on performance data can fuel anxiety and compulsive checking.

Bishop

> **"Self-doubt makes people easily dissuaded by obstacles or failures."**
>
> *— Zimmerman & Bandura*

Q2

How can new authors build confidence and readership?

1



BEYOND OUTCOMES

Final outcomes alone can heighten anxiety—especially for new writers.

2



PROCESS PROGRESS

Specific goals + progress feedback strengthen self-efficacy.

3



AUTHENTIC AUDIENCE

Real reader interaction turns feedback into collaboration.

"Writing without an audience is like not writing at all."

— Heather J.S. Birch

Q3

Do more confident authors publish more frequently?

1



SELF-EFFICACY

Confidence drives persistence, control, and stronger performance.

2



SUPPORTIVE COMMUNITY

Regular feedback helps writers mature—and become more prolific.

3



CONSISTENT OUTPUT

Feedback on habits encourages frequent, persistent writing.

> **"Higher self-efficacy leads to higher goals and firmer commitment."**
>
> — *Zimmerman & Bandura*



FROM THEORY TO PRACTICE

Connecting the Research to KDP

We know what inspires confidence. How do we incorporate those takeaways?

WHO WE SERVE

Three author stages. One shared gap: confidence through context.

1 ALICE

Debut author · 0–1 titles · First 30–60 days

- Has no publishing history to interpret a first launch
- Compares low absolute numbers to viral success stories
- Needs reassurance that slow early activity can be normal

“Is my book landing with the readers I pictured or did I publish into silence?”

2 BOB

Growing author · 2–10 titles · Iterating

- Tests covers, keywords, pricing, and promotion
- Cannot connect a change to a reader outcome
- Needs a unified read of discovery, conversion, and retention

“Did the changes I made reach a wider or different set of readers?”

3 CHARLIE

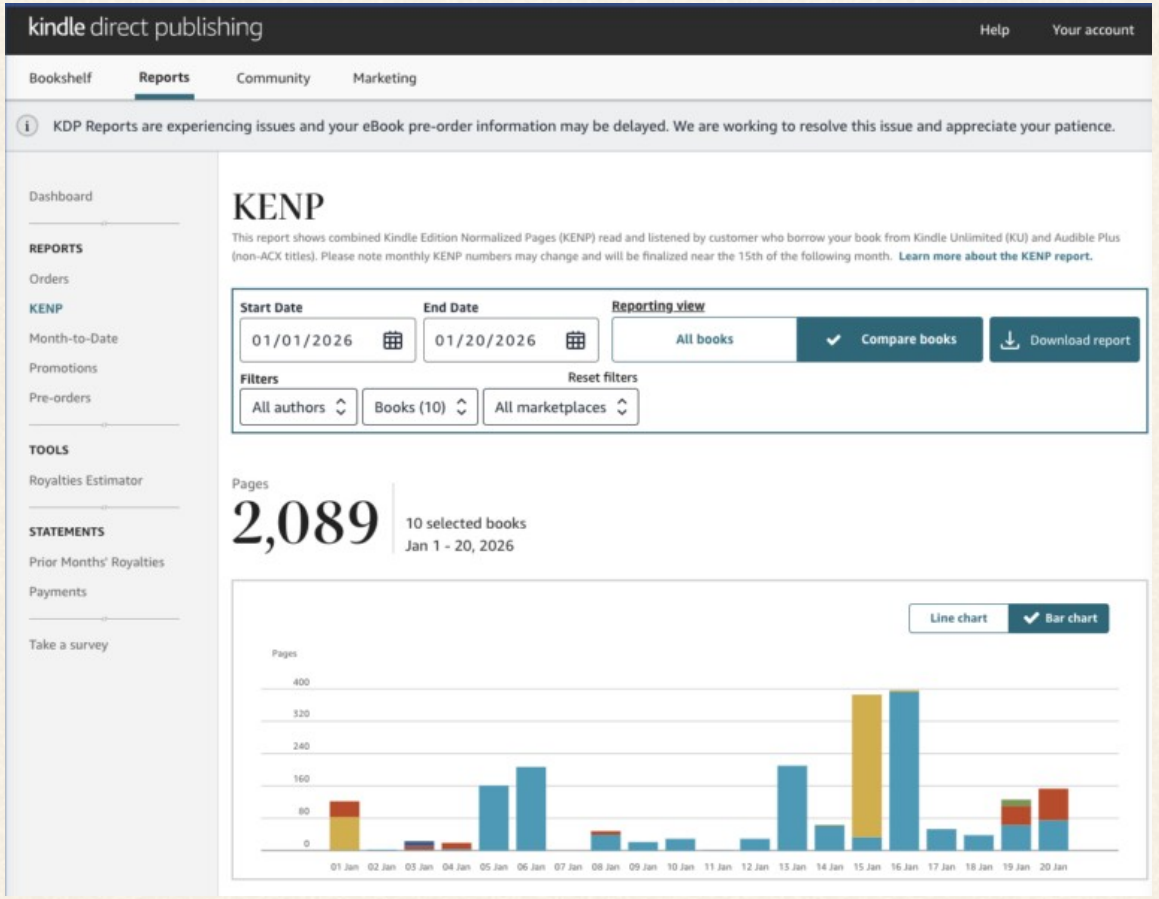
Established author · 10+ titles · Catalog operator

- Needs efficient monitoring across a large backlist
- Generic title-by-title dashboards create too much noise
- Needs early signal on audience and series shifts

“Is my audience following me into this new series or genre?”

THE PROBLEM

KDP gives authors data, but not meaning



WHY THIS MATTERS NOW

Confidence is not cheerleading. It is self-efficacy built on reality.

For Authors: Confidence means Clarity

Seeing Evidence of Progress through Readers Insights

+

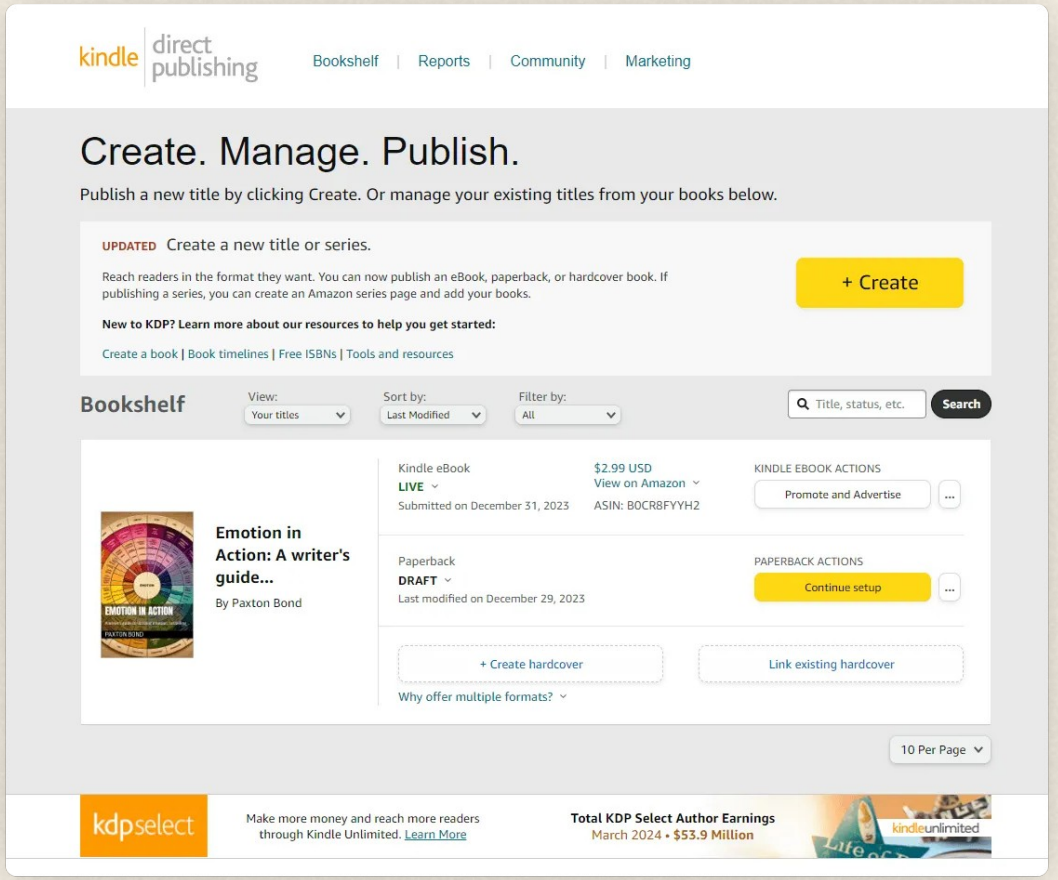
Comparing Performance with Genuinely Similar Peers

For KDP: Confidence means Retention

More returning authors, broader genre participation, deeper catalog growth, and a more durable KDP creator ecosystem.

PRODUCT CONCEPT

CURRENT STATE



PRODUCT EQUITY PROPOSAL

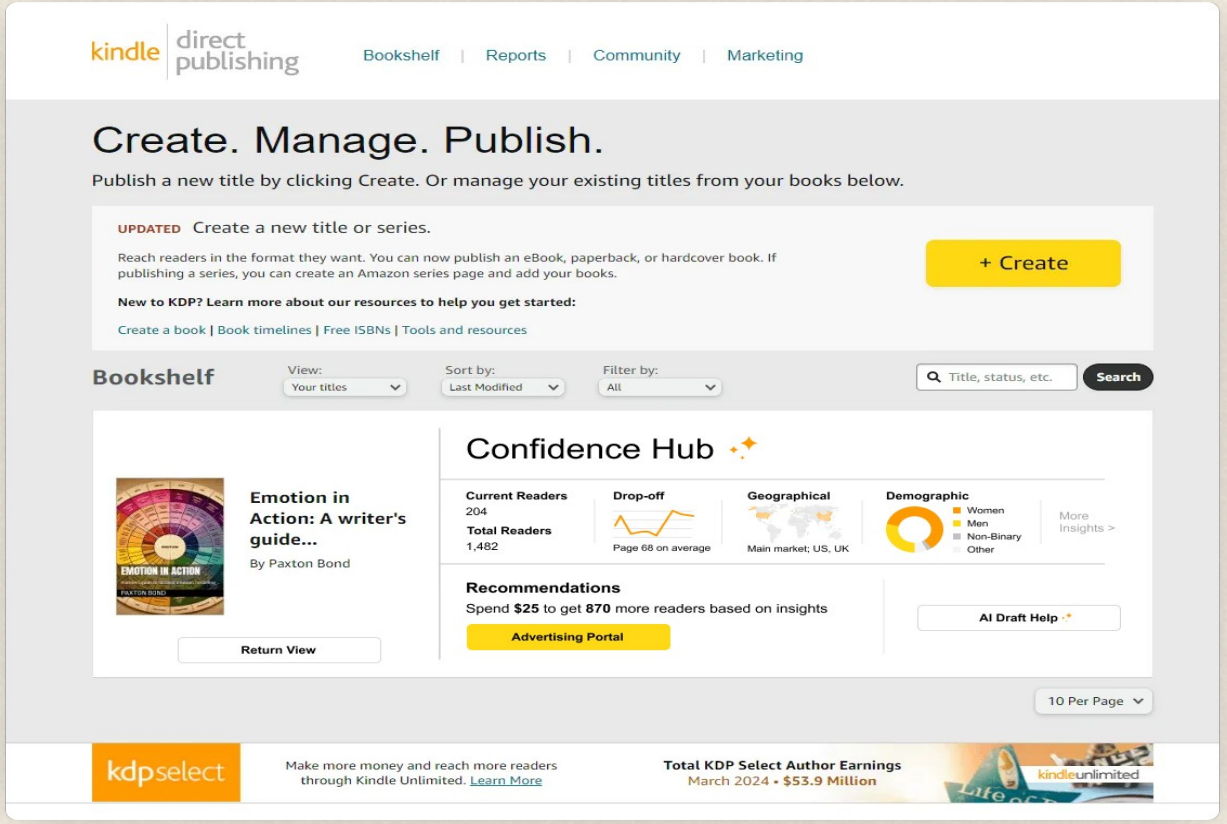
Introducing a “Confidence Hub”

By providing new types of data in an accessible location, authors can understand their audience and work with an invigorated sense of confidence and purpose.



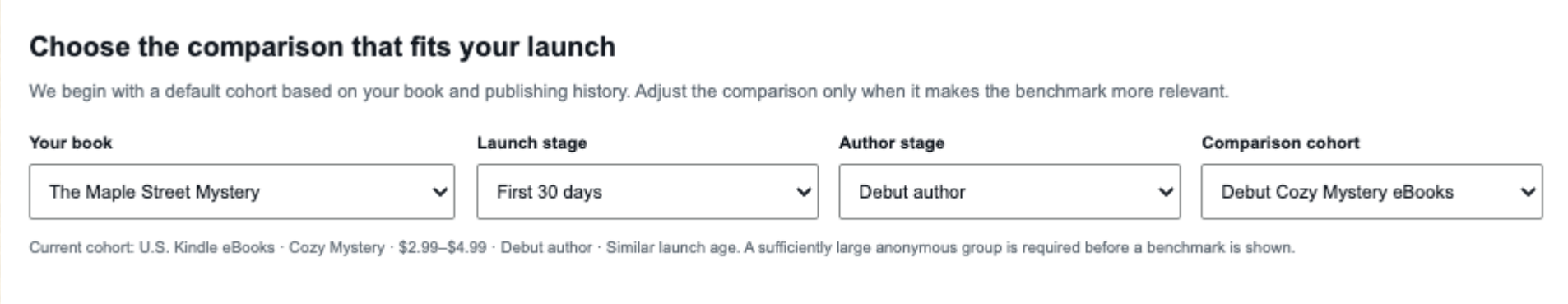
PRODUCT CONCEPT

CONFIDENCE HUB



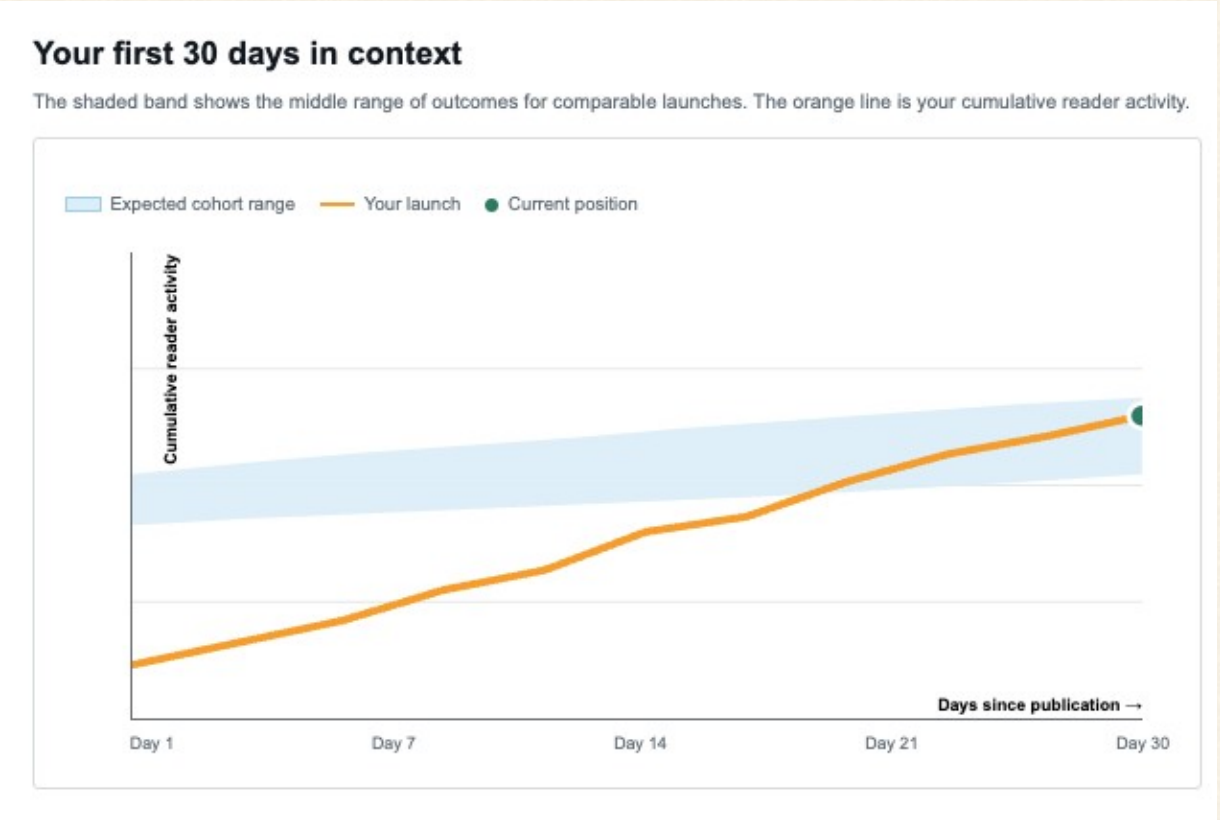
PRODUCT CONCEPT

More Insights in Confidence Hub - Peer Context (Previously Cohort Benchmarking)



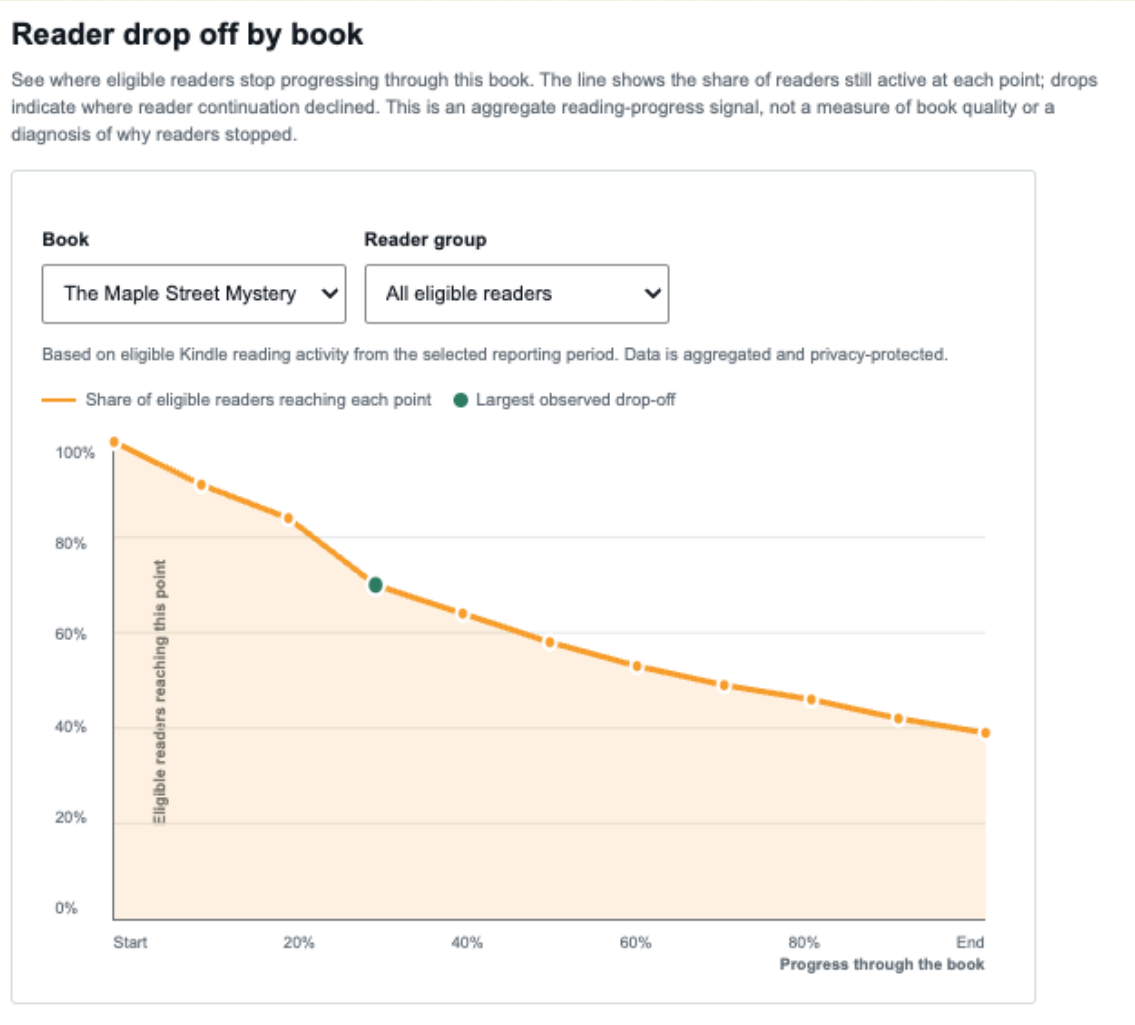
PRODUCT CONCEPT

More Insights in Confidence Hub - Cohort Benchmarking



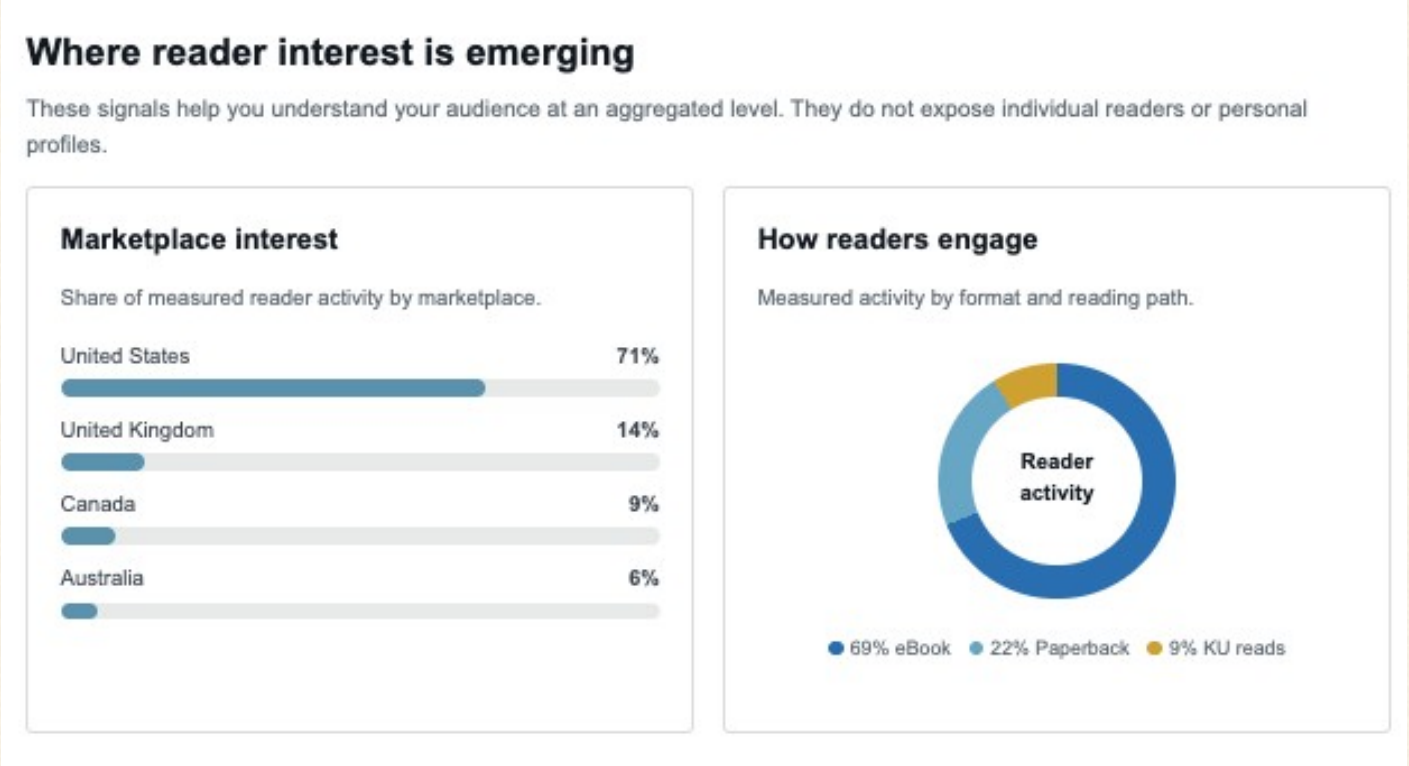
PRODUCT CONCEPT

More Insights in Confidence Hub - Audience Visibility



PRODUCT CONCEPT

More Insights in Confidence Hub - Audience Visibility



Privacy and interpretation note: Audience Visibility uses aggregated activity and minimum reporting thresholds. It does not identify individual readers, reveal protected personal data, or prove that one page change caused an outcome. It is designed to support responsible learning, not to guarantee sales or income.

EMBEDDING EQUITY

A confidence tool is only equitable if the authors who need context most can actually receive it.

Broaden Peer Contexts First

Protect Audiences and Authors

Marketing is not equal to Author Potential

Authors across genre and price bands receive usable insights and confidence lift

HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS

Have more authors who keep publishing

Our north star: Increase the number of debut authors who publish a second title.

North Star

90-day second-title publishing rate.

Confidence Lift

Pre- and post-exposure pulse survey measuring whether the product actually creates informed confidence.

Faster Signal → Action

Time from an identified low-discovery signal to an author-led update.

Equity Guardrails

Cohort availability and retention lift by genre and price band.

MARKET OPPORTUNITY

The author economy has data everywhere. It has trusted context nowhere.

CONFIDENCE EVOLVES WITH AUTHOR

Alice needs a definition of “normal.”
Bob needs evidence that experimentation reached readers.
Charlie needs an early warning system for audience migration across a catalog.

Alternative	What it provides	Critical gap	Confidence Hub advantage
KDP dashboards today	Sales, royalties, page reads, ads reporting	Raw metrics without interpretation or comparable baseline	**Adds private context to data KDP already owns**
Author communities & forums	Peer anecdotes, advice, outlier success stories	Selection bias, inconsistent definitions, no individual baseline	**Uses actual transaction-level signals, not anecdotes**
Third-party newsletters & surveys	Aggregate income and marketing benchmarks	Self-reported, broad, disconnected from an author’s live title data	**Matched cohorts by launch conditions and metadata**
Marketing or analytics tools	Optimization tactics and campaign metrics	Often assumes time, money, and marketing sophistication	**A no-commitment confidence layer for every author stage**

Don’t let a lack of context become the reason the next great author leaves KDP.

Confidence Hub turns the data KDP already has into the confidence authors need to publish again, build an audience, and create lasting income on the platform.

Approve the 16-week pilot. Prove that when authors can see where they stand, more of them choose to keep going.

THAT'S ALL!

Thank you

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